



- Security Consultant, (Computing / Networking / Information Technology)
- Information Security Manager
- Penetration Tester

What is penetration testing?

Penetration testing or pen-testing is a security measure that companies undertake to protect themselves against malicious cyber-attacks. Generally, a white hat hacker is hired to run simulated attacks on the system or network to find out potential loopholes or security lapses in the system that is susceptible to exploitation. Restrictions are virtually absent because the most important objective is to uncover as many security flaws as possible.

Let's discuss these three types of penetration testing prevalent in the industry.

Black Box: The infrastructural information about the organization's network is kept hidden from the ethical hacker. Similar to a black-box, the hacker is on his own to figure out everything. This is done to simulate a completely external attack by someone who has never physically been in an organisation, nor do they know anything about the way it functions.

Grey Box: The ethical hacker during a grey box pen test, is provided with partial information about the network framework. In this case, the simulation is for low level internal threats, and is useful to identify holes exposed to someone with even basic access to information about the workings of the company.